

Google's new API will help to identify vulnerabilities more effectively

The deps.dev API recently announced by Google expands on the deps.dev open source cybersecurity initiative that it started in 2021. Packages from the open source ecosystem are frequently incorporated into software development initiatives. A package



is a group of pre-written code modules intended to accomplish a specific task, such as formatting data. These code modules free developers from having to create every element of their programs from scratch.

A program may pick up vulnerabilities from open source software. In order to mitigate the risk, Google introduced deps.dev in 2021. Cybersecurity information for more than 5 million open source packages is accessible through the project. A software team can determine whether a package has any known vulnerabilities by using deps.dev. It also offers details on

various other topics, such as licensing constraints. Some open source software packages are not compatible with some enterprise software projects because their licences restrict their use for commercial purposes.

According to Google, using the deps.dev data set will be simpler for developers thanks to the new API. The API does this by making it easier to create automation workflows. Google claims that these workflows can identify vulnerabilities and other problems more effectively than before by using data from deps.dev.

An organisation can use the API to build a plugin that connects deps.dev to the code editor used by its developers. Such a plugin may automatically check for vulnerabilities when a developer downloads an open source program. Similar techniques can be used to identify potential licensing problems.

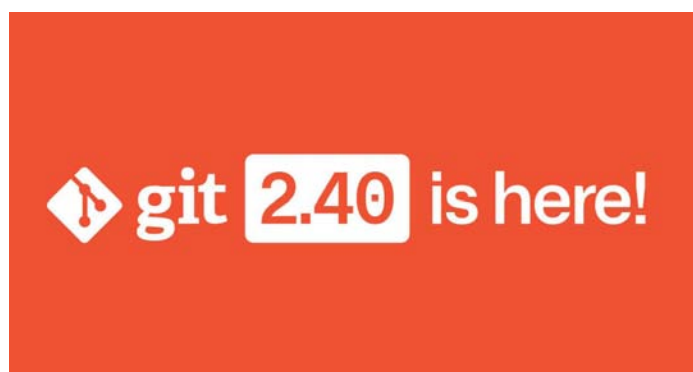
Git 2.40 is now available

The most recent release of the open source Git project, version 2.40, has introduced various new features and bug fixes. Some of the features of this release include improved Windows responsiveness, updates to the git jump tool, and enhancements to the cat-file utility.

Taylor Blau, a staff software engineer at GitHub, gave a comprehensive breakdown of the changes in Git 2.40. The optional git leap tool, which is contained in the Git contrib directory, now supports Emacs and Vim. The git jump utility wraps git

commands like git grep before feeding the results to Vim's quickfix list.

Improvements in Git 2.40 also allow for the replacement of older Perl or Shell code with more up-to-date C code. Git instructions can now execute more quickly on systems like Windows thanks to this. The legacy implementation git add -interactive has been removed, and git bisect is now implemented in C as a native built-in. Version 2.40 of Git includes some upgrades to its CI infrastructure. For Git developers, this means that several resource-intensive, lengthy Windows-specific CI builds have been blocked.



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